

TEACHING TIPS:

- There are lots of words in this song that all need to be sung clearly, so **start with a warm-up that focuses on diction** such as *Peter Piper* from *Sing Warm-Ups*.
- Try to keep the tempo steady and avoid rushing, especially through the faster words.
- Notice that the quavers in the melody are performed 'swung', i.e. with the first quaver lengthened and the second quaver shortened. This is indicated above the score by (♩ = ♪♪) and gives the song its distinctive jazzy feel.

WHAT YOU NEED

Pencils and paper (optional)

LISTEN

For inspiration, listen to the beginning of *The Geographical Fugue* by Ernst Toch. Can they hear each of the four vocal parts or 'layers' come in? Listen out for the accented 'Trinidad' each time.

STEP IT UP!

This song features a key change or **modulation** up a semitone at the beginning of verse 4. Lots of popular songs do this to increase the excitement/intensity towards the end of a song. Listen to *Penny Lane* by The Beatles, *Living on a Prayer* by Bon Jovi, *Perfect Illusion* by Lady Gaga, *Man in the Mirror* by Michael Jackson, the list goes on and on! Can the class identify when the key change occurs and stand up as they hear it?

PITCH

Modulation – the change from one key (tonal centre) to another

Sequence – a repetition of a phrase or melody at a higher or lower pitch

DYNAMICS

Volume

TEXTURE

Layers of sound and rhythm

Notation

Improvise

Sing

Listen

Play

Compose

Genre/History/Musicians

ACTIVITY

AGES 7-11



Explore the lyrics 'the buds

are busy blossoming and blooming', 'it's a bright and breezy, nice and easy feeling', 'daffodils-as-far-as-you-can-see thing', 'skip-along-the-road-and-hum-a-tune thing', 'feather-duster-whistle-while-you're-cleaning' and 'creepy-caterpillar-buzzy-bee thing'.

Speak them rhythmically, as they are sung in the song, and at different dynamic levels e.g. loudly, moderately loudly, quietly. Split the class into small groups. To keep in time, have one group as a steady crotchet pulse repeating 'buds are blooming' over and over. Another group then repeats 'the buds are busy blossoming and blooming' rhythmically over the top. A third group can then add another phrase or 'layer' to the texture, e.g. 'it's a bright and breezy, nice and easy feeling'.

Then ask each group to **compose a 'spoken chorus' or rap**, using some or all of these phrases, lasting between 30 seconds and a minute. They will need to think about how many times each phrase is repeated, varying the texture by using solos and/or duet sections, dynamics, the ensemble skills of coming in together (perhaps having a conductor) and staying in time. They may need to write down who does what and when! They could also include body percussion such as stamping, clapping or clicking fingers as a pulse to help them keep to the beat. Can they perform their compositions to the class?

WHAT'S ACHIEVABLE?

To explore texture in music.

To begin to develop creative thinking through composition.

To perform a 'spoken chorus' or rap, in time as an ensemble.